responses, where the exception of students who believed their parents were less politically active was in the case of a private university in Lahore, where children predominantly came from an elite background. The sample from Sindh also predominantly agreed with the statement that their parents were more politically active than their own generation, a sentiment that was echoed in the 2014–15 focus group at a university in Sindh.

That this difference is a result of their social and political class is a possibility, highlighting Hasan's (2002) analysis of how the 'elite' has politically disengaged. In the focus group with a private university in Karachi students expressed differences of opinion: '*No, I think we are less politically aware because of a plurality of opinions that we are exposed to through the news. Don't know what to believe*' (Focus Group, Private University[31]).

The discussion with students also highlighted how parents today discouraged their children from engaging in political action linked to protests. Emblematic of the parents discussed in Nelson's study, there is a fear that the students might be at risk, not only from other student groups (often dependent on which city or university) but also from the added threat of terrorism (discussed in Chapter 4). One student explained that there was a '*lack of support and motivation from parents because they find it unsafe and somewhat useless*' (Student, Female, Lahore), while others simply stated that they were not allowed. The fact that students need permission for political activism is also indicative of the lack of understanding students have towards politics and what it means to be politically active.

A disconnect with politics was quite evident in the narratives, especially with some honestly admitting that they did '*not understand the political structure of Pakistan*' (Student, Female, Lahore), and others dismissing '*Pakistani politics*' as completely '*worthless*', and hence a waste of time.

The response on their level of political activism also yielded similar results. Figures 2.2a and 2.2b shows the distribution of political activism across institutions, and highlights how predominantly students described themselves as being politically inactive. In Punjab, the exceptions are negligible but include the Islamabad madrassa staff and the students going to NGO/civil society-run schools. For the madrassa staff again their activism was linked to their religious obligations, which seldom translated into political duties and responsibilities, but the NGO students were taught in a community-based school that attempted to create a sense of civic identity. Yet as the graph illustrates the major trend is lack of political activism as described by the participants. In Sindh a similar trend is visible in Figure 2.2b where politics was perceived to be too corrupt a profession for the honest citizen.